International Order
Of
Old Bastards
Illigitimus non carborundum

April News Letter
2026

PATRON
David MANN
AM KSJ
FAICD

Dear members,

I hope you are surrounded by people who are good for your spirit.
You are amazing Old Bastards for facing the present situation with so much typical Assie spirit , courage and hope. The most important thing right now is for us to remain focus on doing what we do best, that is continuing to help and support those in our community that face hardship or find themselves in necessitous circumstances.
In 2026, as we embrace the original spirit that founded our chapter—a spirit of genuine friendship and camaraderie, combined with a healthy dose of light-heartedness—we look forward with optimism to many more years dedicated to serving our community. This enduring sense of mateship and willingness to lend a hand is what continues to define us and inspire our ongoing commitment

"Anzac Therapy" …

" This day is a chance to catch up with mates, have a few beers, share stories, bitch and moan about what happened overseas, but share a laugh and have a good time, you know…, "Anzac Therapy".
This also falls in with the genesis of the IOOB which started by a group of U.S. soldiers on R&R in Queensland being fascinated with the Australian way of life and endearing vernacular "You Old Bastard". So let us remember to always strive to maintain our charter in helping those in necessitous circumstances or at an unfair disadvantage and always be aware that there are 3 types of people.
First, there are people who will say,
"I don't care what happens to other people as long as it doesn't affect me."
Second, there are people who will think,
"How can I rip people off and make money off of this?"
Third, there are people like us the "Old Bastards" who will ask,
"How can I help"

Ian

Lest we forget

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Message from the Arch Bastard

In commemorating Anzac Day, older OBs would have known grandfathers and great uncles who served in the First World War and remember the old photos passed around of those who paid the highest price. We remember fathers, mothers and family in the Second World War, Korean War, and during our early adulthood, the Vietnamese war and later the Iraq and Afghanistan wars. We honour all who served, sacrificed their lives, and established the "Anzac spirit" of courage and mateship. We reflect on the shared loss and sacrifice of all sides, and in the spirit of reconciliation focus on moving forward and seeing the common humanity in opposing forces.
We will remember them.
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Alastair WRIGHT
Arch Bastard (President)

Guest Speaker

Mark 'Squiz' Squirrell OAM

From car bombings to meeting Yasser Arafat and making it to the summit of Mount Everest he has led food convoys through war zones, climbed to the summit of Mount Everest to raise awareness for global hunger, and worked on the frontlines of some of the world's most complex humanitarian emergencies. A former Commando turned United Nations aid worker, his experience spans Gaza, Somalia, Sri Lanka, and beyond

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MEMBERSHIP RENEWALS

2026 membership renewals were due by the 1st of February 2026 at the latest, but it's still not too late to renew your membership.
Members who joined after June 2025 are deemed financial for 2026.
Current membership status
Still Unfinancial for 2025/6 9 for 2026 54

1. Please pay your $25:00 membership renewal by means of EFT to
   Account Name **INT ORDER OF OLD BASTARDS**
   NATIONAL AUSTRALIA BANK
   BSB number 083-802
   Account number 17-940-7264 Reference **Your Name**
   Or you can pay by cheque to the Secretary I.O.O.B,
   78 Bould Road Cardinia Vic 3978.

REPORT ON SOME WE HAVE HELPED

Marek, 74, lives near Monbulk, Victoria. He is a colorectal cancer survivor with chronic heart failure and severe breathing issues, needing further heart and septum surgery. After a recent hospital stay, Marek's home burned down, leaving him uninsured and financially strained. Two dogs died in the fire. He now lives in an old caravan lacking basic amenities, facing unsafe conditions due to his health and the weather. We were able to purchase new reading glasses. And also, purchase a new generator for his caravan.

Dear Members of the International Order of Old Bastards,

I would like to say a very big thank you to all of you for your kindness and help.
After my house fire I lost my home and many things, and it has been a very difficult time for me. I also have some health problems, so life has been quite hard lately. Your help has made a real difference for me.
The generator you bought for me is very important because I can have electricity again while I am staying in my caravan. It will give me light and power for small things and make life a little more comfortable. The reading glasses were also a very thoughtful gift. Now I can read again, which I enjoy very much.
It means a lot to know there are good people who want to help others when they are in trouble. I feel very grateful for your generosity and kindness.
Your help has given me some hope during a very difficult time, and I will not forget it.
Please pass on my sincere thank you to everyone in your organisation.
With many thanks,

Marek Nieczyporuk

2026 Luncheon dates

General Luncheon - Thursday 19 February
Anzac Luncheon - Thursday 16 April
Sports Luncheon - Thursday 25 June
Racing Luncheon - Thursday 20 August
Ladies Luncheon - Thursday 15 October
Christmas Luncheon – Thursday 10th December

Although we have made extensive inquiries into the disappearance of a large number of our Old Bastards Baseball caps, which was a substantial loss to the IOOB. we were unable to solve the mystery, as a result we have now ordered and receive a further ten of the caps which are now available at $30 each

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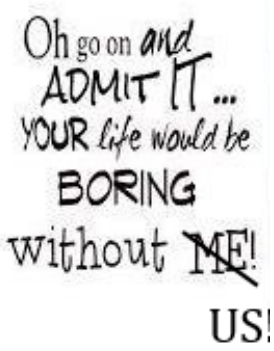
OUR JOKE MASTER - JOHN ALLPORT. LM. BoY AND HIS APPRENTICE John BONE

With the collaboration between John Allport, and John BONE we have been able to keep, and continue the legacy of "John's Jokes." Alive

Copies of John's previous jokes are always available from, the secretary for a small donation at, iob@outlook.com.au .



As we go forward into 2026 and once again enjoying each other's company, don't forget, if any member needs help or assistance, or just wishes to speak with another Old Bastard, the members of the committee are here for you.

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"Don't let the Bastards Wear You Down"!

International Order of Old Bastards

COMMITTEE

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Ian J ARRELL OAM
Honorary Secretary

IOOB-Melbourne-

Alastair WRIGHT
Arch Bastard (President)